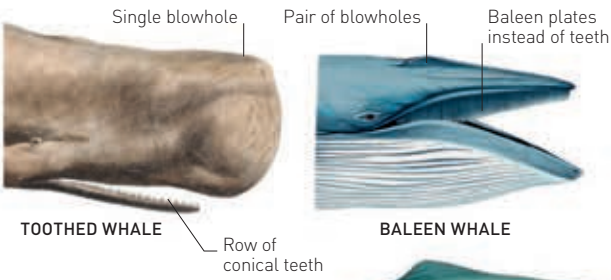


Whales and dolphins

Although they live in water, whales, dolphins, and porpoises are all mammals. At intervals, they rise to the surface to breathe in fresh air and exhale stale air through blowholes, similar to nostrils, on the top of their head.

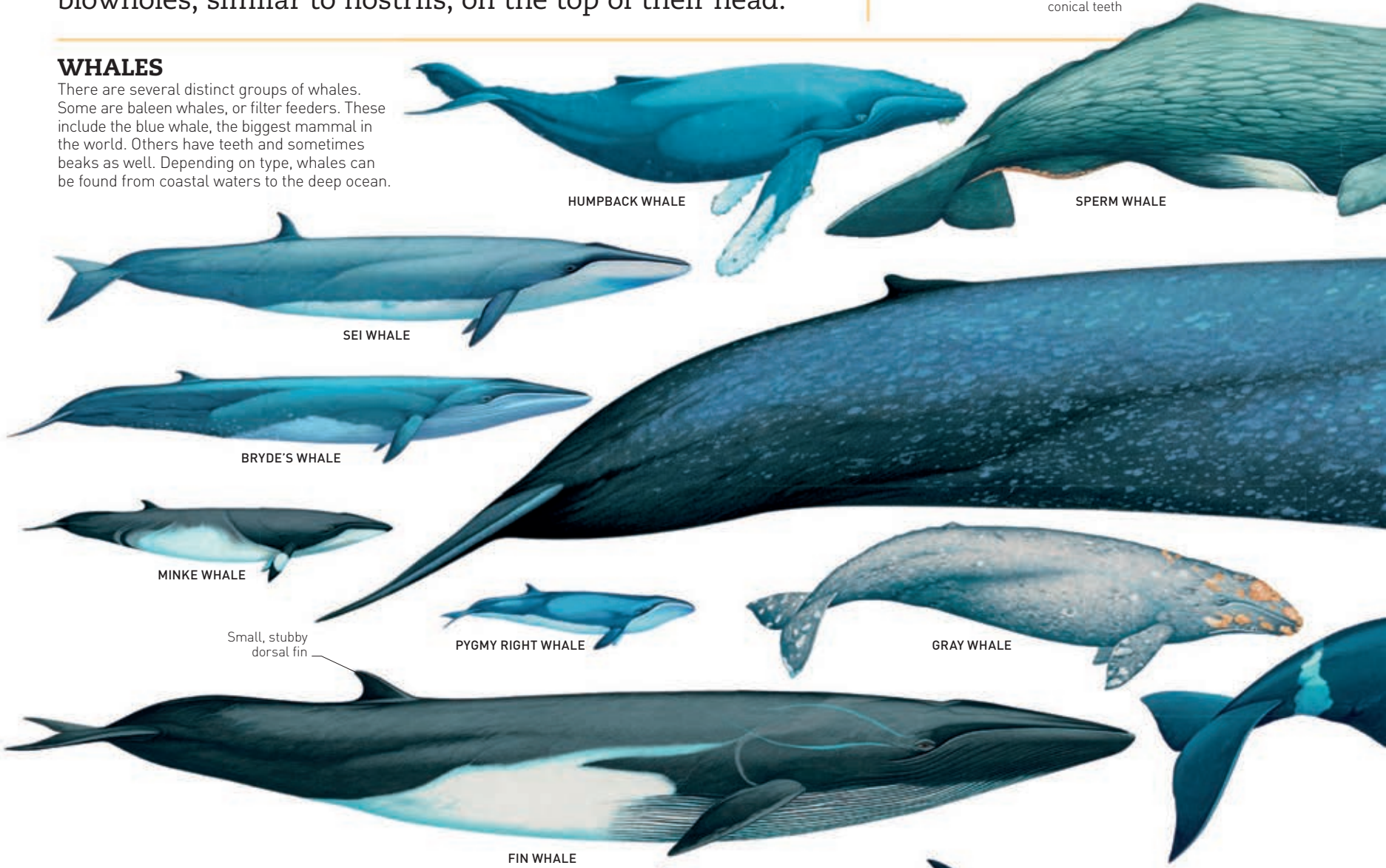
TEETH AND FILTERS

Some whales have teeth for catching prey such as fish or squid. Filter-feeding whales have comb-like plates called baleen hanging from their upper jaw. As they swim, baleen whales gulp water and the plates trap tiny prey.



WHALES

There are several distinct groups of whales. Some are baleen whales, or filter feeders. These include the blue whale, the biggest mammal in the world. Others have teeth and sometimes beaks as well. Depending on type, whales can be found from coastal waters to the deep ocean.



DOLPHINS

Apart from a few river species, dolphins are ocean-dwellers. They come in many patterns. Common dolphin features include a beak and a bulging forehead.

